

LIVE

Learning Space

NEWSPAPER

12th January, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

2nd WEEK



INDIA & TWO STATE SOLUTION

UPSC CSE – GS II

**GS II ... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED
AND DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS**



Learning Space

LIVE



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

12th JANUARY, 2018

2

The road still runs through Ramallah

Advocating the Israel-Palestine peace process is vital for India to restore its influence in West Asia



SUHASINI HAIDAR

Narendra Modi's visit to Israel last year, the first by an Indian Prime Minister, stood out for his decision not to visit the Palestinian territories. Two months before Mr. Modi's visit, even Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's closest ally, U.S. President Donald Trump, had coupled his visit to Jerusalem with a trip to Bethlehem to meet the Palestinian leadership. The decision, India had said, came from a determination to "de-hyphenate" relations with Israel and Palestine. This was underlined in the India-Israel joint statement, which didn't refer to the two-state solution, didn't mention the status of Jerusalem, and didn't even call for an early resumption of the Israel-Palestine peace process.

Strengthening ties

Instead, the two countries focussed on burgeoning bilateral ties, most notably the defence and strategic partnership. By one estimate, India accounts for 41% of Israel's defence exports, and a possible sale of Spike anti-tank missiles during Mr. Netanyahu's visit to India will give this steadfast relationship an added fillip. Counter-terrorism cooperation remains a cornerstone of India-Israel cooperation and there will be a powerful joint remembrance ceremony during Mr. Netanyahu's visit to Mumbai's Chabad House, one of the targets of the 26/11 attack. The biggest growth areas in bilateral ties will also come from memorandums of understanding in agriculture and water technology, given Israeli expertise in this area.



LEFT: NARENDRA MODI

During Mr. Netanyahu's visit to Ahmedabad, where he and Mr. Modi will undertake a roadshow together, he will hand over two de-salinisation vehicles that Mr. Modi saw in Haifa. Showing how little he believed the political context matters to the bilateral relationship anymore, Mr. Netanyahu said that neither China nor India conditioned their relationship with Israel on the basis of the Palestinian peace process. "[Mr. Modi said], I need more water, clean water...where will I get it? Ramallah?" Mr. Netanyahu had told a group of European officials a few days after Mr. Modi's visit.

Difference of a few months

However, the decision to de-hyphenate doesn't seem quite as set in stone as it had just a few months ago. Expectations are that unlike in Jerusalem, Mr. Modi will raise the need to pursue the two-state solution with Mr. Netanyahu directly during the India visit. Mr. Modi is also expected to travel to Palestine in the next few months, and receive Jordanian King Abdullah II in New Delhi, during which the need for the peace process will be highlighted.

At a Non-Aligned Ministerial in September, calling India's support to the Palestinian cause a "reference point" in its foreign policy.

Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj affirmed that India's "expanding relations" in the region will "only strengthen the Palestinian cause", not weaken it. And in a letter ahead of the UN International Solidarity Day with the Palestinian People in November, Mr. Modi wrote that India's vision for the creation of a separate Palestinian state remains, and called for an "early resumption of dialogue".

The biggest shift from what seemed to be a set trajectory for the Modi government, however, came on the floor of the UN General Assembly (UNGA) on December 21, when India chose to vote for a resolution criticising the U.S. for recognising Jerusalem as the Israeli capital, and also called on Israel to end its "occupation that began in 1967". The Foreign Ministry defended its decision as consistent with past policy, but in fact the reverse is evident. In the past three years, barring a vote at the UNGA in 2014, India has turned from its traditional pro-Palestinian stance, to one of abstention. In 2015, India abstained on a UN Human Rights Council resolution criticising Israel for an aerial bombing of Gaza that had left 2,200 people dead. It repeated its abstention in 2016. Also in 2016, at UNESCO in Paris, India

changed its vote from voting "for" to an abstention on a resolution criticising Israel for encroachments at the Western Wall and near the Al-Aqsa mosque in Jerusalem.

Clearly, India could have easily made a case for abstaining on the UNGA resolution on Jerusalem as well, especially given this recent record. The decision was taken despite strong lobbying from Israel in the run-up to the vote, and despite Mr. Trump's open threats to all those voting for the resolution. Another possible tack came from Mr. Trump's own statement when he announced his decision to move the U.S. Embassy to Jerusalem, saying it was not a "final status" position, including on the extent of "Israeli sovereignty in Jerusalem". Bhutan has used that statement to explain its breaking ranks with India at the vote, by choosing to abstain.

Meanwhile, the bogey of "domestic compulsions" used by several governments in the past, a euphemism for objections from India's Muslim minority on the Israel-Palestine issue, has long since been called out: there has been no major 'street' reaction to or protest of any of India's overtures to Israel, or to the visits by the leaders thus far, and the Modi government had no cause to worry about a public reaction to an abstention in this case.

As a result, India's position can only be explained by a desire to reassert its leadership role on the multilateral stage, and to regain its leverage on the Israel-Palestine issue, a re-hyphenation of sorts. This is in keeping with the special place and moral position India has always assumed on the peace process, and its support to a just solution. It is also a rejection of the false equivalence often built between Palestine and Kashmir, or comparisons between de-hyphen-

ating the India-Pakistan relationship and the Israel-Palestine issue. De-hyphenating relations with Israel and Palestine can only follow a peaceful resolution of the issue, which even Israel's founding fathers believed was the two-state solution. "The future of the Zionist project depends on [Israel's] embrace of the two-state solution," former President Shimon Peres wrote in his memoirs. "The danger, if Israel abandons this goal, is that the Palestinians will eventually accept a one-state solution. Because of demographics, this would leave Israel with a choice: stay Jewish or stay democratic." It is this solution that Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin was assassinated for espousing, and Mr. Peres died hoping for – but Israel's current dispensation is moving away from this long-standing consensus.

On principle

Weeks after winning on principle at the UNGA to have its candidate overwhelmingly elected to the International Court for Justice, India could not have been seeing bowing to pressure or to the dictates of 'realpolitik' on the Jerusalem vote at the same forum. More to the point, the government appears to have affirmed that in calculating the national interest, it is necessary to value the role of India's leadership on the international stage as well. If there is a realpolitik calculation to be made, it is that India's influence in West Asia cannot be squandered away so casually, and advocating the peace process with Mr. Netanyahu will be an important step. The road to India's prosperity may well run through Jerusalem, but the road to its leadership aspirations on the world stage cannot bypass Ramallah either.

suhasini.h@thehindu.co.in

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date :12th January, 2018

2 The road still runs through Ramallah

Date :12th January, 2018

Advocating the Israel-Palestine peace process is vital for India to restore its influence in West Asia

Narendra Modi's visit to Israel last year, the first by an Indian Prime Minister, stood out for his decision not to visit the Palestinian territories. Two months before Mr. Modi's visit, even Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's closest ally, U.S. President Donald Trump, had coupled his visit to Jerusalem with a trip to Bethlehem to meet the Palestinian leadership. The decision, India had said, came from a determination to "de-hyphenate" relations with Israel and Palestine. This was underlined in the India-Israel joint statement, which didn't refer to the two-state solution, didn't mention the status of Jerusalem, and didn't even call for an early resumption of the Israel-Palestine peace process.

Strengthening ties

Instead, the two countries focussed on burgeoning bilateral ties, most notably the defence and strategic partnership. By one estimate, India accounts for 41% of Israel's defence exports, and a possible sale of Spike anti-tank missiles during Mr. Netanyahu's visit to India will give this steadfast relationship an added fillip. Counter-terrorism cooperation remains a cornerstone of India-Israel cooperation and there will be a powerful joint remembrance ceremony during Mr. Netanyahu's visit to Mumbai's Chabad House, one of the targets of the 26/11 attack. The biggest growth areas in bilateral ties will also come from memorandums of understanding in agriculture and water technology, given Israeli expertise in this area.

...Contd.



2 The road still runs through Ramallah

...Contd.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date :12th January, 2018

During Mr. Netanyahu's visit to Ahmedabad, where he and Mr. Modi will undertake a roadshow together, he will hand over two desalinisation vehicles that Mr. Modi saw in Haifa. Showing how little he believed the political context matters to the bilateral relationship anymore, Mr. Netanyahu said that neither China nor India conditioned their relationship with Israel on the basis of the Palestinian peace process. "[Mr. Modi said], I need more water, clean water...where will I get it? Ramallah?" Mr. Netanyahu had told a group of European officials a few days after Mr. Modi's visit.

Difference of a few months

However, the decision to de-hyphenate doesn't seem quite as set in stone as it had just a few months ago. Expectations are that unlike in Jerusalem, Mr. Modi will raise the need to pursue the two-state solution with Mr. Netanyahu directly during the India visit. Mr. Modi is also expected to travel to Palestine in the next few months, and receive Jordanian King Abdullah II in New Delhi, during which the need for the peace process will be highlighted.

At a Non-Aligned Ministerial in September, calling India's support to the Palestinian cause a "reference point" in its foreign policy, Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj affirmed that India's "expanding relations" in the region will "only strengthen the Palestinian cause", not weaken it. And in a letter ahead of the UN International Solidarity Day with the Palestinian People in November, Mr. Modi wrote that India's vision for the creation of a separate Palestinian state remains, and called for an "early resumption of dialogue".

...Contd.



2 The road still runs through Ramallah

...Contd.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date :12th January, 2018

The biggest shift from what seemed to be a set trajectory for the Modi government, however, came on the floor of the UN General Assembly (UNGA) on December 21, when India chose to vote for a resolution criticising the U.S. for recognising Jerusalem as the Israeli capital, and also called on Israel to end its “occupation that began in 1967”. The Foreign Ministry defended its decision as consistent with past policy, but in fact the reverse is evident. In the past three years, barring a vote at the UNGA in 2014, India has turned from its traditional pro-Palestinian stance, to one of abstention. In 2015, India abstained on a UN Human Rights Council resolution criticising Israel for an aerial bombing of Gaza that had left 2,200 people dead. It repeated its abstention in 2016. Also in 2016, at UNESCO in Paris, India changed its vote from voting ‘for’ to an abstention on a resolution criticising Israel for encroachments at the Western Wall and near the Al-Aqsa mosque in Jerusalem.

Clearly, India could have easily made a case for abstaining on the UNGA resolution on Jerusalem as well, especially given this recent record. The decision was taken despite strong lobbying from Israel in the run-up to the vote, and despite Mr. Trump’s open threats to all those voting for the resolution. Another possible tack came from Mr. Trump’s own statement when he announced his decision to move the U.S. Embassy to Jerusalem, saying it was not a “final status” position, including on the extent of “Israeli sovereignty in Jerusalem”. Bhutan has used that statement to explain its breaking ranks with India at the vote, by choosing to abstain.

...Contd.



2 The road still runs through Ramallah

...Contd.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

Date :12th January, 2018

Meanwhile, the bogey of “domestic compulsions” used by several governments in the past, a euphemism for objections from India’s Muslim minority on the Israel-Palestine issue, has long since been called out: there has been no major ‘street’ reaction to or protest of any of India’s overtures to Israel, or to the visits by the leaders thus far, and the Modi government had no cause to worry about a public reaction to an abstention in this case.

As a result, India’s position can only be explained by a desire to reassert its leadership role on the multilateral stage, and to regain its leverage on the Israel-Palestine issue, a re-hyphenation of sorts. This is in keeping with the special place and moral position India has always assumed on the peace process, and its support to a just solution. It is also a rejection of the false equivalence often built between Palestine and Kashmir, or comparisons between de-hyphenating the India-Pakistan relationship and the Israel-Palestine issue. De-hyphenating relations with Israel and Palestine can only follow a peaceful resolution of the issue, which even Israel’s founding fathers believed was the two-state solution. “The future of the Zionist project depends on [Israel’s] embrace of the two-state solution,” former President Shimon Peres wrote in his memoirs. “The danger, if Israel abandons this goal, is that the Palestinians will eventually accept a one-state solution. Because of demographics, this would leave Israel with a choice: stay Jewish or stay democratic.” It is this solution that Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin was assassinated for espousing, and Mr. Peres died hoping for — but Israel’s current dispensation is moving away from this long-standing consensus.

...Contd.



2 The road still runs through Ramallah

...Contd.

On principle

Weeks after winning on principle at the UNGA to have its candidate overwhelmingly elected to the International Court for Justice, India could not have been seeing bowing to pressure or to the diktats of 'realpolitik' on the Jerusalem vote at the same forum. More to the point, the government appears to have affirmed that in calculating the national interest, it is necessary to value the role of India's leadership on the international stage as well. If there is a realpolitik calculation to be made, it is that India's influence in West Asia cannot be squandered away so casually, and advocating the peace process with Mr. Netanyahu will be an important step. The road to India's prosperity may well run through Jerusalem, but the road to its leadership aspirations on the world stage cannot bypass Ramallah either.

2

The road still runs through Ramallah

Advocating the Israel-Palestine peace process is vital for India to restore its influence in West Asia



SUHASINGI HAIDAR

Narendra Modi's visit to Israel last year, the first by an Indian Prime Minister, stood out for his decision not to visit the Palestinian territories. Two months before Mr. Modi's visit, even Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's closest ally, U.S. President Donald Trump, had coupled his visit to Jerusalem with a trip to Bethlehem to meet the Palestinian leadership. The decision, India had said, came from a determination to "de-hyphenate" relations with Israel and Palestine. This was underlined in the India-Israel joint statement, which didn't refer to the two-state solution, didn't mention the status of Jerusalem, and didn't even call for an early resumption of the Israel-Palestine peace process.

Strengthening ties

Instead, the two countries focussed on burgeoning bilateral ties, most notably the defence and strategic partnership. By one estimate, India accounts for 41% of Israel's defence exports, and a possible sale of Spike anti-tank missiles during Mr. Netanyahu's visit to India will give this steadfast relationship an added fillip. Counter-terrorism cooperation remains a cornerstone of India-Israel cooperation and there will be a powerful joint remembrance ceremony during Mr. Netanyahu's visit to Mumbai's Chabad House, one of the targets of the 26/11 attack. The biggest growth areas in bilateral ties will also come from memorandums of understanding in agriculture and water technology, given Israeli expertise in this area.



GETTY IMAGES/ANTONY DUNN

During Mr. Netanyahu's visit to Ahmedabad, where he and Mr. Modi will undertake a roadshow together, he will hand over two de-mineralisation vehicles that Mr. Modi saw in Haifa. Showing how little he believed the political context matters to the bilateral relationship anymore, Mr. Netanyahu said that neither China nor India conditioned their relationship with Israel on the basis of the Palestinian peace process. "Mr. Modi said, I need more water, clean water...where will I get it? Ramallah?" Mr. Netanyahu had told a group of European officials a few days after Mr. Modi's visit.

Difference of a few months

However, the decision to de-hyphenate doesn't seem quite as set in stone as it had just a few months ago. Expectations are that unlike in Jerusalem, Mr. Modi will raise the need to pursue the two-state solution with Mr. Netanyahu directly during the India visit. Mr. Modi is also expected to travel to Palestine in the next few months, and receive Jordanian King Abdullah II in New Delhi, during which the need for the peace process will be highlighted.

At a Non-Aligned Ministerial in September, calling India's support to the Palestinian cause a "reference point" in its foreign policy.

Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj affirmed that India's "expanding relations" in the region will "only strengthen the Palestinian cause", not weaken it. And in a letter ahead of the UN International Solidarity Day with the Palestinian People in November, Mr. Modi wrote that India's vision for the creation of a separate Palestinian state remains, and called for an "early resumption of dialogue".

The biggest shift from what seemed to be a set trajectory for the Modi government, however, came on the floor of the UN General Assembly (UNGA) on December 21, when India chose to vote for a resolution criticising the U.S. for recognising Jerusalem as the Israeli capital, and also called on Israel to end its "occupation that began in 1967". The Foreign Ministry defended its decision as consistent with past policy, but in fact the reverse is evident. In the past three years, barring a vote at the UNGA in 2014, India has turned from its traditional pro-Palestinian stance, to one of abstention. In 2015, India abstained on a UN Human Rights Council resolution criticising Israel for an aerial bombing of Gaza that had left 2,200 people dead. It repeated its abstention in 2016. Also in 2016, at UNESCO in Paris, India

changed its vote from voting "for" to an abstention on a resolution criticising Israel for encroachments at the Western Wall and near the Al-Aqsa mosque in Jerusalem.

Clearly, India could have easily made a case for abstaining on the UNGA resolution on Jerusalem as well, especially given this recent record. The decision was taken despite strong lobbying from Israel in the run-up to the vote, and despite Mr. Trump's open threats to all those voting for the resolution. Another possible tack came from Mr. Trump's own statement when he announced his decision to move the U.S. Embassy to Jerusalem, saying it was not a "final status" position, including on the extent of "Israeli sovereignty in Jerusalem". Bhutan has used that statement to explain its breaking ranks with India at the vote, by choosing to abstain.

Meanwhile, the bogey of "domestic compulsions" used by several governments in the past, a euphemism for objections from India's Muslim minority on the Israel-Palestine issue, has long since been called out: there has been no major "street" reaction to or protest of any of India's overtures to Israel, or to the visits by the leaders thus far, and the Modi government had no cause to worry about a public reaction to an abstention in this case.

As a result, India's position can only be explained by a desire to reassert its leadership role on the multilateral stage, and to regain its leverage on the Israel-Palestine issue, a re-hyphenation of sorts. This is in keeping with the special place and moral position India has always assumed on the peace process, and its support to a just solution. It is also a rejection of the false equivalence often built between Palestine and Kashmir, or comparisons between de-hyphen-

nat shi De-rael a p whi ers lati pro tra fon wec ger, tha ly a cau lea ish sol hak poc ing dis thi

On We at i ove tem coo ing 'rec at i pol has the sar der as v cul dia' be anc wit por pro jer der sta eit — ash

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... EFFECT OF POLICIES AND POLITICS OF DEVELOPED AND DEVELOPING COUNTRIES ON INDIA'S INTERESTS

IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

India is committed to the two-state solution for the Israel-Palestine issue and enumerate various steps, which strengthen this ideology.

DE-HYPHENATION ... INDIA'S EARLIER STANCE

Mr. MODI
PM, INDIA



BENJAMIN NETANYAHU
PRIME MINISTER, ISRAEL

- 1** Last year Indian Prime Minister visited Israel for the first time. He took the decision not to visit the Palestinian territories.
- 2** Two months prior to that even the USA President Donald Trump visited Jerusalem with a trip to Bethlehem to meet the Palestinian leadership.
- 3** India at that time said that it is determined to de-hyphenate relations with Israel and Palestine.



SYRIA

Cyprus

Mediterranean Sea

LEBANON

IRAQ

ISRAEL

JERUSALEM

BETHLEHEM

JORDAN

EGYPT

SAUDI ARABIA

Gulf of Aqaba

DE-HYPHENATION ... INDIA'S EARLIER STANCE



Mr. NETANYAHU
PM, ISRAEL

Counter-terrorism cooperation is the cornerstone of India-Israel relations.

- The Joint Statement did not refer to the two-state solution. It did not mention the status of Jerusalem. It did not even call for an early resumption of the Israel-Palestine peace process.
- The two countries focussed on bilateral ties, especially in the defence and strategic partnership.
- Now, India accounts for 41% of Israel's defence exports and now possible sale of Spike anti-tank missiles is expected during Mr. Netanyahu's visit.

DE-HYPHENATION ... INDIA'S EARLIER STANCE



Mr. NETANYAHU
PM, ISRAEL



Mr. MODI
PM, INDIA

VISIT OF Mr. NETANYAHU IN
JANUARY, 2018

- 1 During the visit, both the leaders will undertake road show.
- 2 Israel will hand over two desalinisation vehicles.
- 3 More MoUs are expected in agriculture and water technology.

NOW, INDIA IS REVERTING BACK TO THE DECADES-OLD STRATEGY

- 1 Indian Prime Minister is expected to raise the need to pursue the two-state solution.
- 2 Mr. Modi is expected to travel to Palestine in the next few months.
- 3 India is expected to receive Jordanian King Abdullah II in New Delhi and the need for the peace process will be highlighted.
- 4 Recently, Foreign Minister, Sushma Swaraj stated that India's expanding relations in the region will only strengthen the Palestinian cause.
- 5 Ahead of the UN International Solidarity Day (December, 20) with the Palestinian People, the Prime Minister wrote that India's vision for the creation of a separate Palestinian state remains and called for an "early resumption of dialogue".
- 6 On December 21, India voted for the resolution criticizing the U.S. for recognizing Jerusalem as the Israeli capital.
- 7 It also called on Israel to end its occupation that began in 1967.



WHAT ARE THE POSSIBLE REASONS FOR THE CHANGE IN STANCE?

- 1 It appears to be the desire to reassert its leadership role on the multilateral stage.
- 2 It is to regain the leverage on the Israel-Palestine issue, that means, a re-hyphenation.
- 3 It is in tune with the moral position, India always assumed on the peace process. This is even in tune with the ideology of Israel's founding fathers, who believed that it is the two-state solution, which is the cornerstone of future of the Zionist project.



The road to India's prosperity may run through Jerusalem, but the road to its leadership aspirations on the world stage cannot bypass Ramallah either.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

Amrita Naidu
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
D. Chaitanya

K. Srikanth
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 - 2 4 4 4 4 7 2
0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9